

Chapter 21

Yin Lingzhu looked silently at the message Yan Si sent, tossed her phone aside, and didn't reply.

On the other side, Yan Si waited and waited, but seeing no message from Yin Lingzhu, she didn't know what to send either.

The brief conversation ended just like that.

However, what made Yan Si happy was that Yin Lingzhu had released her from the blacklist.

Yin Lingzhu lay on the bed, contemplating whether to file for divorce.

But this idea was quickly dismissed. Her career was currently on the rise—if news of a divorce suddenly broke, it would definitely have an impact.

She was afraid of the impact, but wasn't Yan Si afraid too?

Thinking of this possibility, Yin Lingzhu's eyes lit up and she picked up her phone.

【If you don't want to divorce, aren't you afraid I'll reveal our marriage to the public?】

【Not afraid.】

Seeing the reply, Yin Lingzhu felt an inexplicable surge of resentment.

What exactly did Yan Si want? Would she only be satisfied after taking her life?

Yin Lingzhu bit her lower lip. Her originally rosy lips instantly turned pale, until they bled.

The metallic taste and pain in her mouth pulled Yin Lingzhu's thoughts back. She released her teeth from the soft flesh and stared blankly at the ceiling.

Tears slowly slid from the corners of her eyes, seeping into her hair.

Let Yan Si do whatever she wanted, as long as she didn't come bothering her, it didn't matter.

Yin Lingzhu thought dejectedly. She realized that the more contact she had with Yan Si during this time, the softer her heart became.

She was afraid that one day, she would truly forgive Yan Si for what she had done to her.

She wouldn't see her next week, she thought.

The variety show was a completely closed environment.

Yan Si looked at her chat record with Yin Lingzhu and drove toward You Xiaoxiao's company.

You Xiaoxiao's work was very leisurely—generally, no one came to inquire about gland-related matters.

Seeing Yan Si arrive, You Xiaoxiao brought her to her break room.

"Lingzhu wants to divorce me."

You Xiaoxiao hadn't even sat down when she heard this sentence. She froze mid-air, and it took her a while to react before sitting stiffly in her chair.

"Weren't you two supposed to divorce anyway?" You Xiaoxiao's tongue seemed unable to straighten itself.

Yan Si looked out the window, her gaze filled with confusion, "I don't want to divorce."

"Yin Lingzhu loves you so much. If you hadn't brought up divorce, she definitely wouldn't divorce." You Xiaoxiao said matter-of-factly.

In her view, Yin Lingzhu was willing to give up her glands, risk her life, and willingly have her pheromones extracted—she definitely loved Yan Si to the bone.

Yan Si also heard the meaning in You Xiaoxiao's words and lowered her eyelashes, "She brought it up."

"I don't want to divorce. I like her."

Hearing Yan Si's words, You Xiaoxiao couldn't respond for a long time.

As someone who had grown up with Yan Si since childhood, she knew very clearly just how cold-blooded Yan Si really was.

That year with the Yan family could be described as brutal.

All the collateral relatives were caught by Yan Si with evidence—the least got five years, the longest got life imprisonment.

Some of Yan Father's illegitimate sons received the gift package of broken arms and legs before going in, and Yan Father was now paralyzed in bed.

Back then, Yan Si had taken control of the Yan family with thunderous methods, showing no mercy.

No one had expected Yan Si to be like this.

After all, on the surface, Yan Si was Yan Father's most beloved daughter.

But Yan Si knew that Yan Father simply had no choice but to dote on her.

He allowed other illegitimate sons and daughters to enter the Yan family ancestral home and bully her wantonly where her mother couldn't see.

Yan Si had carefully hidden herself—no one had seen the hatred in her heart.

Therefore, just after graduating from university, although Yan Si told Yan Father she wanted to develop her career elsewhere, she was actually secretly collecting evidence.

Yan Si lay dormant for a year. After ensuring everything was foolproof, she sent everyone in one by one.

You Xiaoxiao had witnessed everything happen.

Therefore, she understood how ruthless Yan Si's heart was and how deep her thoughts ran.

Now Yan Si was telling her she had someone she liked—this was a huge shock to You Xiaoxiao's worldview.

She had always thought someone like Yan Si would die alone.

However, despite being shocked, having been by Yan Si's side for so long, she quickly calmed her emotions, "Yin Lingzhu wants to divorce. Do you know why?"

"Did you do something to betray her?"

You Xiaoxiao sensitively cut off her words, not saying the rest. Things Yan Si had done to betray Yin Lingzhu—there were far too many.

"Perhaps if you coax her, it'll be fine." You Xiaoxiao said.

You Xiaoxiao was someone who had been single since birth¹. The advice she provided wasn't very useful either.

"With your looks and family background, very few people can compare. As long as you show her a little more patience, she'll definitely change her mind."

Listening to You Xiaoxiao's words, Yan Si thought about what she had done during this period.

"Mm, I understand. I'll go first." Yan Si dropped this line and quickly left.

You Xiaoxiao watched Yan Si's departing figure, her heart full of question marks.

She just left like that? Didn't ask more questions, and what did she understand?

Yan Si didn't tell her what she had done during this time.

She had accepted an invitation to a small variety show for Yin Lingzhu's sake, and tricked Yin Lingzhu into sleeping in the same bed with her.

In the past year, she actually hadn't had much physical contact with Yin Lingzhu.

Her office had a separate monitor that played surveillance from the apartment.

Her phone also had an app linked to the surveillance.

When she was free from filming, she would take out her phone and open the surveillance. When she was in the office, she could also see what Yin Lingzhu was doing in the apartment at any time.

She very much enjoyed watching Yin Lingzhu busying herself for her, but she didn't dare to go see Yin Lingzhu.

She didn't dare reveal her feelings for Yin Lingzhu.

Yan Father couldn't control his lower body²—he had countless illegitimate daughters and sons.

Yan Si remembered there was an illegitimate daughter who had always been kept outside.

Suddenly one day, that illegitimate daughter broke into the Yan family's old mansion. At that time, Yan Si's grandmother, Yan Father, Yan Mother, and Yan Si were eating dinner.

Before there was time to think about how she got in, Yan Father's expression changed and he wanted to drive her away.

But that girl hugged Yan Father's thigh, saying her mother wanted to see him.

In the end, Yan Father still went.

Yan Father had many lovers, but they fell into two categories: for money or for love.

The girl's mother was for love.

She lived in a tiny, shabby rental apartment. Yan Si hid outside the door, secretly watching what happened inside.

Sunken eye sockets with dark purple circles, pale lips without any color, hair messy on the pillow. Her voice was like fingernails scraping tree bark, harsh and grating: "You came."

Her voice carried happiness, making it not quite so unpleasant, but still unpleasant.

Yan Father took her to a five-star hotel and took care of her for a few days.

Yan Si later went to the hotel to see her. Yan Father was there too.

But the girl's mother wasn't as happy as before. Her eyes stared at Yan Father, full of resentment.

Yan Si didn't understand—it had only been a few days, why such a big difference?

The girl's mother looked at Yan Father, "You shouldn't have come to see me."

"You doing this makes me feel it's meaningless. I just wanted to get your love, just wanted..."

Yan Father was silent for a while, then left.

Yan Si found her words incredible.

Taking advantage of Yan Father's departure, Yan Si immediately came before the girl's mother and asked her confusion—why had she changed so much?

The girl's mother looked at little Yan Si, "My daughter has a doll she likes, has liked it for a long time. It's very expensive. Every day after school she goes into the store to look at it."

"Cough, cough. Later for her birthday, I spent a month's salary to buy it for her."

"She played with it for a few days, then got tired of it. She said she now liked another doll."

The girl's mother's cloudy eyes stared at Yan Si, "But I know, if I hadn't bought her that doll, the doll she liked wouldn't have changed."

"What you can't get is always the best."³

The girl's mother struggled to say this last sentence, then unwillingly breathed her last, eyes wide open, dying on the bed.

This scene had a tremendous impact on eight-year-old Yan Si.

She remembered that last sentence.

Yan Si was afraid she would become that doll.

Footnotes:

¹ **Single since birth (母胎單身):** Chinese slang literally meaning "single from the womb," referring to someone who has never been in a romantic relationship.

² **Couldn't control his lower body:** A euphemistic Chinese expression for someone who is sexually promiscuous or unfaithful.

³ **"What you can't get is always the best":** This reflects a common psychological principle often expressed in Chinese culture—that people tend to value most what they cannot have, and lose interest once they obtain it.